I was thirteen, and I was tired of hanging out at the local toy shop to play Intellivision games. I wanted my own videogame console. I'd been bugging my parents for a while, with no success.

Then I found an alternative: I could play games on a computer as well. So I asked my parents to buy me one of those new 8-bit computers—you know, to learn useful stuff. My dad agreed, and my mom took me to the shop and bought me a Sinclair ZX Spectrum.

Mom, Dad… Here is something that I should've told you more often in my life: thank you. This book is dedicated to the two of you. I'm hoping it will make you proud, just like your once-kid is proud of you. And while I'm here, I have something to confess about that life-changing day thirty years ago: I didn't really want to learn stuff. I just wanted to play.

In fact, that's what I've been doing all these years.